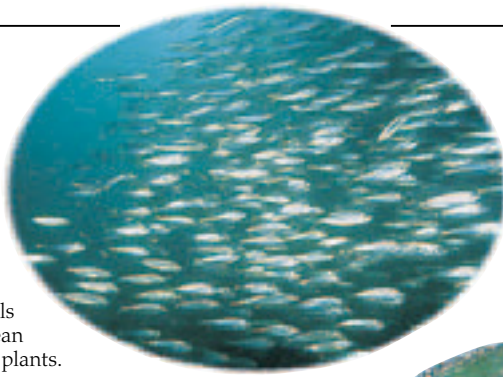


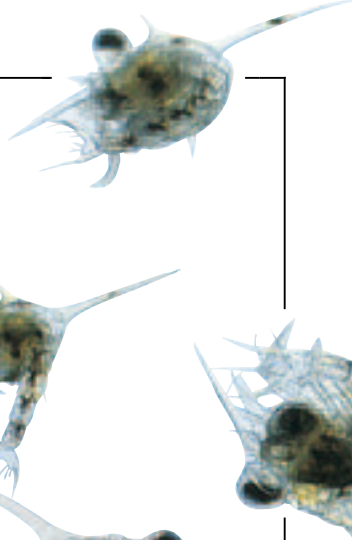


TO EAT AND BE EATEN

Among the ocean's top predators, dolphins hunt fish by their sonar system (echo location), producing a series of clicks which bounce back off nearby objects. Dolphins fall prey to larger animals like killer whales, while the fish they eat hunt smaller fry. Few ocean animals feed on just one type of food, but almost all must rely on plants.



Shoal of sardines



Copepod
(water flea)

Younger stage
crab larva

Younger stage
crab larva

Shrimp

A sample of zooplankton
collected from the north
Atlantic coast of Scotland

Younger
stage crab
larva

Younger stage
crab larva

Young fish

Younger stage
crab larva

Opossum
shrimp

Copepod
(water flea)

PLENTY OF PLANKTON

A great variety of zooplankton drift in the ocean.

Some are plant-eaters feeding on smaller phytoplankton.

Among the most abundant plant-eaters are copepods and tiny crustaceans (animals with jointed limbs, like crabs). They draw phytoplankton into their mouths by creating a current with their antennae. Young stages of crabs and shrimp go through several forms while in the plankton before settling on the seabed. Some have spikes on their bodies for floating, which also make them awkward to eat. Many fish (not sharks) also start off life in plankton. First they feed on their egg sac, then on other types of plankton.